

Christy Sheppard

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SUMMARY

I'm a software developer with experience building production web applications for enterprise insurance clients. I sit comfortably at the intersection of technical and client-facing work — having served as a primary technical liaison while contributing across the full breadth of a fast-moving insurtech platform. I've most recently contributed to AI-powered development, including a Claude API-powered conversational insurance interface and MCP-based backend integrations — and am actively growing my skills in LLM integration, because in an industry being reshaped by AI, standing still isn't really an option.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript (ES2020+), TypeScript, Bash

Frontend: React, Next.js, Chakra UI, Shadcn UI, Tailwind CSS, React Hook Form, SWR

Backend: Node.js, REST APIs, Express, SST (Serverless Framework)

Database: MongoDB, AWS DynamoDB

Cloud & Infra: AWS (Amplify, Cognito, CloudWatch, IAM), GitHub Actions CI/CD, Sentry

AI / MCP: Anthropic Claude API, MCP (Model Context Protocol), LLM adapter pattern

Testing: Jest, React Testing Library

Other: Shopify, WordPress, Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign)

EXPERIENCE

Software Developer — **Buddy Technology** *June 2022 – Present*

ION Architecture & Partner Implementation — Primary Role

- Designed and built Insurance Object Notation (ION™) data models for enterprise carrier partners including Allstate and Aon, translating complex insurance products into Buddy's structured data format for digital deployment
- Managed the full ION build process from initial product digitization through carrier approval and go-live, including API connectivity for quoting, binding, endorsements, refunds, emails, and forms
- Troubleshoot and solved unique partner implementation challenges — custom payment methods, state-specific compliance requirements, endorsements — often contributing fixes upstream to shared libraries

Enterprise Technical Liaison — Allstate & Aon

- Coordinated with implementation partners (Vero, Remax, Payscore, Avail, Jobble, Snap Finance, Progressive Leasing) on technical onboarding, documentation, and ongoing product evolution

AI & Agentic Development — Most Recent

- Collaborated closely with the MCP architect to build a carrier-facing demo chat interface — including conversational insurance quoting, binding, and inline Stripe payment flow
- Contributed to MCP design decisions by surfacing integration requirements discovered during chat development, resulting in targeted improvements to the MCP itself
- Designed the interface to be white-label configurable with carrier-specific theming, making it adaptable for different client deployments

Backend & Infrastructure

- Built user management system with Cognito-backed listing, org scoping, role filtering, pagination, and full deletion workflow with test coverage
- Designed and shipped single-policy renew and customer charge endpoints with role-based authorization scoped to customer, producer, and admin access levels

Senior Visual / UX Designer — **PopMount, Inc.** *August 2018 – June 2022*

- Converted all e-commerce industry sites from RapidWeaver to Shopify; built and maintained all e-commerce websites alongside design and maintenance of internal WordPress and Shopify sites
- Created in-house graphics, templates, marketing materials, and digital outreach for internal use and outside business partnerships
- Processed daily print production orders using Photoshop, Illustrator, and InDesign

Senior Creative Services Designer — **Nexstar / Media General** *2011 – 2017*

- Designed and implemented digital solutions for clients advertising across a network of 170+ broadcast television stations
- Produced dynamic digital products including banner ads (rich media, video, static), e-blasts, and responsive splash pages
- Managed multiple projects and team members simultaneously in a high-paced environment

Earlier career in web content management and digital publishing — Richmond.com / Richmond Times-Dispatch (prior to 2011)

EDUCATION

University of Richmond Coding Bootcamp Certificate — August 2021 – February 2022

Completed while working full time at PopMount, Inc.

University of Maryland, Baltimore County — Imaging and Digital Arts, Animation Track; Art History Minor | 1999–2003